

Why do people still use AI even after the environmental and ethical consequences that come out of it?

Posted by u/Least-Care6506 • • 0 points • 4 comments

As I'm starting to enter the 'real' world, leaving my school education to go into college and start working on my future, this questions keeps coming through my head. The UN has declared a water bankruptcy and everyday I hear more and more about how AI datacenters are affecting communities. When I walk into my english class (that is supposed to be college level) everybody has chatgpt open and only me and one other person seem to actual answer the teachers basic questions over what we just read in class.

I understand that AI is not going anywhere anytime soon no matter what and that it is so profitable for companies that they will never do anything about it, but still I feel concerned. I understand it's convenient and quick, but do people not feel their cognitive abilities declining? I too once used to rely on AI for my assignments, but decided to stop when I realized that my intellectual ability was diminishing and I couldn't do simple reading comprehension.

I am just worried for my own generation's future. I feel like I'm going crazy from how anxious I am about what will happen, but everyone seems to be fine about it. Everyone my age who wants to be doctors heavily relies on AI for their work. So many people I know are using chat gpt for therapy. How will that even play out in a few years? Thank you for any and all responses, greatly appreciated.

Comments

u/TooManyBison • 1 points • 2026-02-18 07:35 UTC

I use it because my boss will fire me if I don't.

u/Least-Care6506 • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:59 UTC

that does make sense, i just realized that many web developers and the tech field are probably have to use it with the rise of it being everywhere. thank you for your answer!

u/archpaw • 4 points • 2026-02-18 05:55 UTC

The environmental impacts are often [vastly overstated](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>). What it comes down to is that it's as bad for the environment as anything else that costs that much in terms of electricity, which for how normal people use AI, is very little. As for the ethical concerns, a lot of people think pre-AI copyright was already going too far. And now people want to expand it so that anything in any way based on someone else's work needs their permission. The point of copyright is to encourage the production of IP. Requiring AI pay people for permission to use their training data isn't going to give them more money and result in people making better training data for better AI. It just makes AI more expensive and worse.

u/Least-Care6506 • 1 points • 2026-02-19 00:04 UTC

thank you for the source. i've been having a lot of anxiety towards ai and the environmental aspects of it and actually having a source to refer will definitely help SO MUCH!!!! and yeah i get what you mean, it isn't really avoidable. i just hope more and more people use it as a tool and not an answer machine.